AIM-YA Instructor Training Guide

AI Mindfulness for Young Adults · A quick read before you facilitate

What AIM-YA is

AIM-YA helps students build a healthier relationship with AI as the technology keeps changing. Many young adults feel AI anxiety: worry about learning, jobs, attention, and staying present. The program pairs mindfulness with practical AI awareness so students can stay thoughtful, ethical, and in charge of their own thinking.

How it's structured

- **Four weeks.** Each week, students open a web-based app and work through brief videos with accompanying worksheets.
- **Small groups.** Students work together in small groups.
- **Same four beats every week**, in this order:
    1. **Mindfulness practice.** A brief mindfulness-based practice.
    2. **Reflection.** Time for students to reflect.
    3. **Hands-on lab.** Students try that week's exercise with an AI tool.
    4. **Check-in.** A short check-in to close.

Your role: guide, not lecturer

- Open space for students to think and talk.
- Keep a steady pace through the four beats.
- Support honest conversation.
- Welcome curiosity, and welcome skepticism too.

The lab

Students use an LLM tool of their choice, whatever they already have access to, to try that week's exercise.

If you're running AIM-YA as part of a research study

- Students complete Qualtrics pre and post measures **after they provide consent**.
- Research participation is **voluntary** and **separate from course grades**.

The takeaway

That's the map. Guide with curiosity, welcome skepticism, and help students practice **being present humans in an AI-saturated world**.